

# Moonsea Rising - 20240727

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In the caboose, the dark-haired assassin looks at Taevyn and says, "what did you say?" He tells her he expected Uriah -- his father -- back here. She tells him Uriah's son died years ago. She asks him his sister's name, if he is who he says he is. He tells her Uriah didn't have a daughter. The assassin, Clarissa Vellen, tells him she is Uriah's only living child, and his fraud is poorly crafted. He is shocked, but tells her it's complicated, and exhorts her to stop this, no one else needs to die. She pauses, and treats her wounds with a powder from her pack. She keeps her weapon trained on Taevyn, however, and tells him that she'll take him to Uriah and they'll see what's what.

Nikolai deftly plucks the arrow from Beitris' arms, stuffing a small cloth from his pack into the gash. Looking at her, he asks her why they're trying to kill everyone, telling her the train is set to explode when it reaches Tgorsk. Horror fills her face, as she lurches toward Lirael, trying to warn her. Lennox, behind her, leaps to the train top, and races across the car towards the engine.

Uriah finishes his decouple, and sidles back into the car, away from Lirael. Eyeing her cautiously, he says to Beitris, "so, you're not Zhentarim?" She looks at him incredulously. "I'm wearing the full regalia of a cleric of Lathander. I am not Zhentarim." She claims her name, and he scoffs, as he knows this timeline's Beitris Marsk, and she is not the other. Beitris unloads on him, using the full brunt of her vocabulary, to tell him that she knows who she is. Uriah turns to Nikolai in confusion, asking the other man what is going on. With the zone of truth bonging and clanging along with the priestess' words, the men stare at her.

Taevyn attempts some fancy footwork, but stumbles and falls. Raising to his feet, and trying to look like nothing happened, he and Clarissa take off towards the engine, with Harken telekinetically and invisibly dragging his skull-bag behind him. Looking at the parley happening in the passenger car, Lirael swings onto the roof and knuckles quickly towards the engine. Behind her, Lennox hurdles the gap, closing with her.

In the car, Uriah asks Beitris who she works for. The assailants tell her that she thinks Ironclaw was manipulated into backing this project, which is a Zhent plot to create war between Thar and Melvaunt. Uriah tells her he's seen visions of the apocalypse, of the grand war that's coming to the Moonsea. He draws a card from his armor, bearing the sigil of the Temple of Xul'Jarak. However, the image is clearly from before it was lost, showing the gates inside the gaping maw of a roaring orc. Uriah repeats to her that he's seen the end, and knows what happens. Beitris brandishes The Dagger, and tells him they're on the same side, and she's seen the visions.

At that, Taevyn and Clarissa burst into the car. He looks around, drawing up short when he sees Uriah. After identifying the man he tells him, "it's me, papa. It's Taevyn, your son." He tells Beitris this is a cruel trick, and that the son that would have been Taevyn died in an orc raid. She tells him in her timeline, he is the one who died in that raid. The man slumps to a seat on one of the train benches. Taevyn approaches him and tells him, "I never got a chance to meet my father." Uriah tells him Taevyn was eaten by the orcs in his infancy. The orcs on the train all look... uncomfortable, adjusting their modern finery and muttering about barbarism. Taevyn tells him he'd like to get to know the man he never knew. Uriah stares at him for a second, and tells him he has his mother's eyes. Beitris looks pointedly at the zone of truth surrounding them as Taevyn, eyes streaming, embraces Uriah.

One of the orcs stands up and says, "well, isn't this touching?" Placing her hand lightly on Uriah's chest, the man fled backwards out the window and off the train. Clarissa yells, "no!" She dives out the window after him, as Taevyn and Beitris immediately move to the attack.

Harken arrives just as the orc shimmers and transforms into an auburn-haired human female, in full Lathandrite armor. Lady Beitris Marsk frees her weapon and straightens up. Harken arrives, takes in the conflict, and smacks Dark Beitris with his telekinetic hand, attempting to create a diversion. Taevyn, rapier in hand, dives out of the moving traincar after Uriah, and Nikolai comes up behind him, pressing the attack. He yells, "Tris, you bitch, you're not going to get a way with this." She blocks his arm as he swings, and knocks the sword from his hand. She tells him, "Nikolai, you were always so soft. I can't believe I ever had feelings for you." Moving her hand and speaking in guttural tones, a cone of shadowy lightning fills the traincar. The passengers are fried where they stand, as Nikolai, Harken, and Beitris as all wracked with the dark magicks. Beitris attempts to tackle her through the window and out of the train. The other woman isn't expecting it, and both tumble out through the window. Tris rolls her shoulder, and lands on top of Beitris, rolling off and coming quickly to her feet. Beitris rolls, fling a vial of holy water which explodes in a burst of magic. Tris spins, catching most of the blast on armor.

Clarissa, meanwhile, has made it to Uriah, and appears to be checking his injuries. Harken summons an phantasmal killer tearing at her mind. Lirael drops into the engine, returning to her normal form, and enters the engine. She finds it empty, no sign of the gnome or the engineer. She and Lennox quickly examine the control scheme, and she finds the magic rod that controls the train appears to have been removed.

Taevyn quaffs a potion, looks at Clarissa, and tells her he needs to help his friends. He races towards Beitris and Tris. Nikolai, still on the train, tries to check the orc civilians, and starts herding those in good enough shape towards the back.

Snarling, and mistake the caster, Tris fires killer phantasms back at Beitris, scoring the woman's psyche. "Tough. I won't miss you." She sprints towards the train, looking to leap back on. Groaning, Beitris rises to her feet, summoning Lathander's grace to ease her wounds.

Clarissa leaps at the passing end of the caboose, barely making it back on the train. Harken watches all this wryly. He messages Nikolai, telling him Tris is attempting to get back on the train. Nikolai asks him who it is, but Harken stands mute.

In the engine, Lirael summons the powers of the mage card, and figures out that, absent the control rod, she'd need to start removing the gems from the outside of the engine, which are protected by a force field. However, she thinks that she could potentially derail the train, if she could do enough damage to the tracks. She moves to the door to the engine and tells Lennox, "get everyone off the train!" He looks at her, and grabs his axe, moving towards the back.

Taevyn nimbly leaps onto the nearest car and strikes a parry pose, waiting for Tris to try and re-board. She leaps onto to the VIP car, and disappears inside. Beitris jumps up beside Taevyn, healing his wounds as Clarissa races past towards the car with Tris and Harken. He steps into the hallway, as Tris is racing forward. As she passes, he extends his hand into her head, attempting to drain her life force. He's rebuffed, as she barrels on, barely noticing his attempt. Taevyn enters the back of the VIP car just as she passes him, taking cover behind the back wall. Nikolai enters from the other end.

Tris whirls around, sensing Harken's malign intent. Identifying his likely location, she rips a phantasmal killer at him, but the shade is unaffected. Beitris continues advancing behind her more fleet colleagues.

From between the engine and luggage cars, Lirael shoots into the air, landing it a fiery blast 60' ahead of the train. The tracks are blasted and twisted beyond recognition, and she quickly moves directly away from the tracks, hoping to avoid the impending derailment.

Completely unaware of the coming disaster, Clarissa catches up with Taevyn, firing her crossbow at Tris and missing. Taevyn stabs at her, his weapon scoring a line across her armor, but otherwise ineffectual. As he dances around her, Nikolai presses his attack as well, but the Marsk woman stands her ground. Uriah leaps onto the train as well.

As Tris is about to strike Taevyn she looks up, alarmed. A portal opens, and she steps through it, disappearing. Beitris follows Taevyn, catching up with him in the VIP car.

As the train hits the damaged track, a lot of things happen very quickly. The uncoupled cars spill off the tracks, clacking and bouncing off one another, rolling across the countryside. Those in the cars are tossed about, though most of Lirael's friends manage to brace for impact, getting knocked about, but managing to survive Faerûn's first train derailment.

The engine, miracle of miracles, remains upright, plowing up the turf and squalling to an inglorious stop some hundreds of feet from Lirael. She braces for a blast that never comes, opening her eye after several seconds in pure wonder. She looks at the giant iron beast, steaming slightly in the grass. As the groans start arising from the smashed cars, she turns, and walks back to where her friends are, hopefully, alive.